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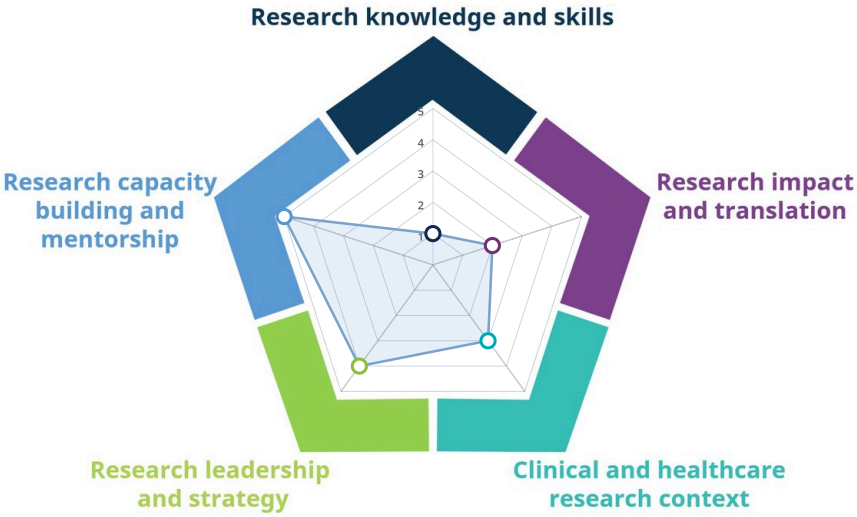
Allied Health Research Careers Development Framework Self-Assessment Tool

My Capability Profile

My Scores

Research knowledge and skills	1
Research impact and translation	2
Clinical and healthcare research context	3
Research leadership and strategy	4
Research capacity building and mentorship	5



Understanding Your Self-Assessment Profile

This self-assessment provides a comprehensive overview of your current research capabilities. As you review your results, it is important to view your scores as a baseline for professional growth and career planning, rather than a definitive performance measure.

Before reviewing your specific domain feedback, please consider the following context regarding your results:

Variation across domains is expected: It is common to demonstrate different capabilities and proficiency levels across the five domains. Expertise is typically focused within specific areas of practice, and a varied capability profile is a standard reflection of an individualised and developing career.

Different roles require different capability profiles: The framework encompasses a broad spectrum of clinical and research positions. Consequently, different roles naturally require different capability and proficiency levels. Advanced skills in certain domains are simply not required for some role types. Differences in capability profiles do not imply that any particular profile or role is less capable or valuable than another.

Scores reflect opportunity alongside ability: The development of capabilities is heavily influenced by the context in which you work and the training and development opportunities available to you. A lower score often highlights a lack of previous opportunity to practice and demonstrate those specific skills within your service, rather than a reflection of your inherent aptitude or potential.

Applying your results: Your profile provides a snapshot of your existing strengths and establishes a baseline for your development journey. If your capabilities currently align well with your service needs and role requirements, this tool serves to validate your practice.

If you are looking to advance or broaden your scope, your results can be used collaboratively with your manager or mentor to identify targeted training, navigate new opportunities, and formulate a structured professional development plan.

Your Domain Feedback

Domain 1: Research knowledge and skills (Average Score: 1.0)

This domain reflects the technical knowledge and skills required to do research across all stages of the research study lifecycle, from planning to dissemination.

What your score suggests

Your overall score suggests emerging proficiency in this domain. This typically reflects early-stage exposure to research concepts and activities, or limited opportunities to engage across the full research lifecycle. This is common for health professionals whose primary role has focused on clinical practice, education, or leadership rather than research. At this level, your understanding of research processes is developing, and skills are often applied with guidance or support from others.

How these capabilities can currently be applied

Allied Health professionals at this level can apply these capabilities by:

- Participating in existing research, quality improvement, and service evaluation projects.
- Reviewing and critically appraising the literature.
- Contributing to data collection or research implementation activities for local research projects led by others.
- Engaging in research discussions within their clinical, discipline, or service context.

How to strengthen or develop your capabilities

To continue to build skills and confidence in this domain, development activities are best focused on foundational research skills and opportunities to apply learnings with support from research experts. Useful strategies may include:

- Undertaking introductory training in research or evidence-based practice (e.g., short courses, graduate certificates, or discipline-specific workshops).
- Engaging in basic literature review or critical appraisal activities linked to your clinical area.
- Joining a local journal club or attending internal research forums.
- Observing or participating in an existing research or service evaluation project.
- Identifying a research mentor or supervisor within your service or professional discipline.
- Familiarizing yourself with local governance and ethical requirements for basic project submissions.

Where possible, focus your development within areas closely aligned to your clinical practice or service priorities.

Domain 2: Research impact and translation (Average Score: 2.0)

This domain focuses on competencies related to ensuring research is translated into practice and has an impact on society. This may be through evidence-based practice, knowledge translation, and embedding impact in the design and conduct of clinical research.

What your score suggests

Your overall score suggests emerging proficiency in this domain. This typically indicates a basic awareness of research translation and impact, with significant opportunities to further develop your understanding of how to bridge the gap between research findings and clinical application (often referred to as moving from “bench” to “bedside”). At this level, you are likely beginning to see the link between evidence and practice but may require guidance to navigate the complexities of sustainable implementation.

How these capabilities can currently be applied

Allied Health professionals at this level can apply these capabilities by:

- Identifying and understanding the current evidence and clinical guidelines that inform local practice.
- Presenting research findings or evidence summaries to your department, local consumer groups, or other non-research audiences.
- Collaborating with local Quality Improvement (QI) teams to support service evaluation.
- Participating in local service development activities to observe how research informs and influences practice changes.
- Promoting the use of evidence-based practice within your immediate clinical setting.

How to strengthen or develop your capabilities

To build your skills in translating research into practice, development should focus on understanding the frameworks that guide sustainable implementation and the roles of various stakeholders. Useful strategies may include:

- Undertaking dedicated training in research translation, knowledge translation (KT), or research impact.
- Leading or participating in a local evaluation of clinical practice to see the translation cycle in action.
- Attending local health research events and forums to learn how others have successfully embedded impact into their work.
- Identifying a mentor with expertise in implementation science or knowledge translation to provide direct support.
- Learning about different stakeholder groups and how their influence affects the adoption of new evidence in a clinical setting.

- Familiarizing yourself with the different types of research impact and exploring how impact is measured or reported locally.

Focus your development on moving from a passive awareness of evidence to active participation in activities that demonstrate how that evidence changes local patient care or service delivery.

Domain 3: Clinical and healthcare research context (Average Score: 3.0)

This domain includes the unique competencies required to conduct research in a clinical or healthcare context, including ensuring research projects are embedded appropriately in the context.

What your score suggests

Your overall score suggests a consolidating to advanced proficiency in this domain. This reflects a proven ability to independently identify clinical research needs and apply research findings to improve service delivery and patient care. At this level, you recognize that research is not a separate activity but a fundamental component of ensuring safe and high-quality clinical practice. You are likely adept at navigating the “clinician-researcher” nexus and are beginning to influence how your peer group views evidence-based practice.

How these capabilities can currently be applied

Allied Health professionals at this level can apply these capabilities by:

- Formulating and refining clinically relevant research questions that address identified local practice gaps.
- Leading the synthesis of research findings to enable direct implementation into local clinical workflows.
- Facilitating clinical research networks to ensure study designs remain focused on improving patient health outcomes.
- Presenting clinical research findings at health service or organizational forums to drive local awareness.
- Contributing to peer-reviewed publications that specifically focus on improving clinical practice and service delivery.
- Actively building relationships with the Research Governance Office (RGO) to streamline project approvals and compliance.
- Influencing patient care by effectively combining your expert clinical and research skills.

How to strengthen or develop your capabilities

To further develop your proficiency, focus on transforming scientific findings into systemic service improvements and mentoring others along the clinician-researcher pathway. Useful strategies may include:

- Designing research protocols that embed considerations of translation and impact from the earliest planning stages.
- Mentoring early-career clinicians in developing their own research skills and navigating the balance of clinical and research roles.

- Seeking formal feedback from multidisciplinary team members on your research communication and project management skills to refine your leadership approach.
- Leading larger-scale evaluations of clinical services to demonstrate the value of research in a healthcare business context.
- Engaging in more complex stakeholder management to ensure research projects align with broader health service strategic priorities.
- Maintaining a high-level understanding of health systems at a broader local or national level to contextualize your work.

Focus your development on mastering the strategic integration of scientific findings into systemic service improvements.

Domain 4: Research leadership and strategy (Average Score: 4.0)

This domain includes those competencies required to lead research strategy, research projects, or teams, including research staff.

What your score suggests

Your overall score identifies you as a strategic leader capable of driving and developing research culture and capacity at an organizational level. This score reflects advanced to expert proficiency in the leadership of research staff and strategy. At this level, you possess the expertise to move beyond the management of individual teams toward shaping the research ecosystem and driving systemic organizational change.

How these capabilities can currently be applied

Allied Health professionals at this level can apply these capabilities by:

- Setting the long-term directions and priorities for clinical research and innovation through high-level organizational committees.
- Implementing robust organizational models that support the seamless operationalization of research within clinical business units.
- Serving as a strategic conduit between clinician-researchers and executive leadership to ensure research is recognized as a primary driver of high-quality health services.
- Maintaining high-level partnerships with academic and industry leaders to sustain significant, multi-sector research collaborations.
- Mentoring senior clinicians and established clinician-researchers to support their transition into formal research leadership roles.
- Establishing a firm reputation as a leader who actively drives the agenda in your research field and challenges traditional ways of thinking.
- Serving on key research committees beyond your immediate organization, such as external strategic advisory committees or major grant review panels.

How to strengthen or develop your capabilities

At this expert stage, development focuses on scaling local successes to the broader health system and navigating complex, system-level healthcare landscapes. Useful strategies may include:

- Formalizing comprehensive career frameworks for clinician-researchers that ensure statewide workforce sustainability and professional development.
- Leading the development of research governance and ethics policies that reduce barriers to multi-site clinical innovation.
- Negotiating large-scale funding and resource allocations at a state or national level to support emerging research priorities.

- Driving cultural change by advocating for the value of research in health service performance and patient safety frameworks.
- Contributing to the design of health system policies that integrate research productivity into standard Allied Health workforce metrics.
- Leveraging your deep understanding of the strategic landscape to anticipate future directions and effectively champion highly promising, disruptive ideas.

Focus your development on building the institutional structures and legislative or policy environments that allow a thriving research culture to become a permanent, resilient feature of the health system.

Domain 5: Research capacity building and mentorship (Average Score: 5.0)

This domain includes competencies related to building research capacity in researchers and healthcare staff, including one-on-one mentorship, education, and contributing to the structure of research.

What your score suggests

Your overall score suggests advanced to expert proficiency in this domain. Averaged from 15 individual domain capabilities, this score identifies you as a clear leader with demonstrated strategic leadership in cultivating a sustainable research workforce.

How these capabilities can currently be applied

Allied Health professionals at this level can apply these capabilities by:

- Serving as a primary advocate and driver of research culture within the organisation.
- Consistently developing and adapting capacity-building strategies to ensure long-term sustainability and operational alignment of research.
- Shaping the institutional ecosystem to normalise research as a core clinical function.
- Providing formal supervision associated with a research degree (e.g., honours, PhD).
- Contributing directly to the strategy and structure of research mentoring and supervision across the broader organization.

How to strengthen or develop your capabilities

Development opportunities at this stage will focus on broad, system-level strategic influence and infrastructure. Specific activities to support this development can include:

- Leading system-level mentorship frameworks.
- Developing and celebrating formal clinician-researcher career structures and positions, including highlighting their outputs and impacts.
- Influencing system-level strategy to secure research resourcing and infrastructure.
- Establishing national and international strategic alliances between health services, universities, and industry to co-invest in research centers or groups.
- Sharing successful models of research operationalisation and capacity building with national and international groups to influence how other health services approach research integration.
- Evaluating and adapting different research-informed development practices on a macro scale to continually refine institutional educational strategies.

Next Steps: Actioning Your Results

As you reflect on your capability profile, please remember that it is not necessary or expected to achieve high proficiency across every domain. Professional development is a targeted process, and you do not need to address every area for improvement simultaneously.

To effectively translate your self-assessment into actionable growth, consider the following next steps:

Focus your efforts: Select one to three specific development areas to prioritise. Ensure these focus areas are relevant to the direction you want your career to take, your current role requirements, and the broader strategic needs of your service.

Set SMART goals: To create a focused and relevant professional growth plan, translate your chosen development areas into SMART goals. Ensure each goal is:

- **Specific:** Clear and unambiguous, so you know exactly what you are working towards.
- **Measurable:** Quantifiable or observable, allowing you to track progress and know when the goal has been achieved.
- **Achievable:** Realistic and attainable within your current role, resources, and time constraints.
- **Relevant:** Aligned with your research career aspirations and the operational needs of your organisation.
- **Time-bound:** Tied to a clearly defined timeline, including specific starting and target completion dates.

Collaborate with leadership: We strongly encourage you to discuss your self-assessment and development plan with your line manager, allied health leader, or a trusted research mentor. Collaborative planning will provide additional perspectives, help refine your strategies, and ensure you can agree on appropriate and meaningful opportunities to contribute your unique capabilities to your service.

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